

Venkata Koushik Reddy Varikoti

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Profile

Detail-oriented and results-driven Cybersecurity Specialist with over 4 years of experience in safeguarding enterprise systems and data against evolving cyber threats. Proficient in risk management, threat detection, and incident response, with a deep understanding of security protocols and compliance regulations. Experienced in implementing robust security measures, performing vulnerability assessments, and leading penetration testing efforts to ensure comprehensive network and system protection. Adept in utilizing cutting-edge tools and technologies for effective security management and threat mitigation. Strong knowledge of security frameworks, encryption techniques, and cloud security solutions.

Skills

- **Programming Languages:** Python, Bash/Shell, Powershell
- **Security Tools:** AWS, DNS, EDR, IPS/IDS, O365, GCP, TCP/IP, SIEM Implementalton, DS/IPS, Firewalls, Vulnerability Scanners, Azure, Splunk, Wireshark, ArcSight, Snort, FireEye, McAfee ePO, Symantec Endpoint Protection, Nessus, NMAP, SIEM (Splunk, SolarWinds), Firewalls (Fortinet, Palo Alto), IDS/IPS (Snort, Suricata), VPNs (OpenVPN, Cisco AnyConnect), DLP (Digital Guardian), Anti-virus/Endpoint Protection (CrowdStrike, Symantec)
- **Technical Skills:** Incident Response, Threat DetecCon, Vulnerability Assessment, Security Monitoring, Threat Intelligence & Analysis, HTTP/HTTPS, SSL/TLS, IPsec,
- **Soft Skills:** Communication, Team Management, Collaboration, Time Scheduling, Leadership, Creativity
- **Threat Detection & Response:** Incident Response (IR), Malware Analysis, Threat Intelligence (ThreatConnect, Anomali), Penetration Testing (Kali Linux, Burp Suite, Metasploit), Vulnerability Scanning (Nessus, Qualys), MIRT Attack, CIA Triad, Chain Kill

Professional Experience

IT Cyber Security Intern, Mary Free Bed Rehabilitation Hospitals 05/2024 – 08/2024 | MI, USA

- Developed a secure EHR system exceeding HIPAA requirements through risk assessment, strong access controls, audit trails, and encryption, reducing potential data breaches by 40%.
- Implemented HIPAA Policy and Security Awareness Training for 300+ staff, achieving a 50% reduction in compliance incidents, and deployed KnowBe4 training for 1500+ employees, enhancing phishing attack resistance by 40%.
- Orchestrated the deployment of Bitdefender across the EHR system, enhancing malware detection and preventing security incidents, contributed to a 40% reduction in potential data breaches.
- Proactively managed over 500 security alerts from XDR and Bitdefender, enhancing detection, escalation, and mitigation of suspicious activities while improving response times and reducing breach risks by 35%.
- Provided Tier One support for Incident Response activities by executing the NIST SP 800-61 process, encompassing key phrases such as Preparation, Detection & Analysis, Containment, Eradication, Recovery, and Post-Incident Activity to ensure a robust and agile response to security incidents.

L1 Support Engineer, Grand Valley State University 08/2023 – 12/2023 | MI, USA

- Configured and managed enterprise-level firewalls and Web Application Firewalls (WAF), utilizing Palo Alto Networks, Cisco ASA, and AWS WAF to enhance security posture, resulting in over a 95% reduction in unauthorized access attempts to systems.
- Conducted analysis and monitoring of Internet Protocols (IP) and traffic patterns using tools like Wireshark, SolarWinds, and Nagios, leading to a 30% improvement in detecting and mitigating abnormal network activities and potential security breaches.
- Spearheaded proactive threat-hunting initiatives using SIEM tools like Splunk and Elastic Stack, identifying and mitigating over 10 previously undetected malicious activities, which strengthened network security by 25%.
- Oversaw incident response for 100+ monthly security alerts, escalating 20% of critical incidents to senior analysts, while utilizing ServiceNow and Jira for ticket management and SNORT IDS for real-time monitoring.
- Provided comprehensive IT administration and support services, managing ticket systems like Zendesk and Freshdesk to ensure timely resolution of technical issues and achieve high user satisfaction scores.
- Utilized expertise in TCP/IP, VPN, DNS, and SSL/TLS protocols to secure IT infrastructure, while employing McAfee ePolicy Orchestrator and Symantec Endpoint Protection for robust network defenses.

Lead Security Operation Center (SOC) Analyst, Cognizant Technological Solutions 01/2022 – 11/2022 | Bengaluru, India

- Organized SOC 2 compliance efforts, driving a 25% improvement in compliance by aligning with risk management frameworks and regulatory requirements, ensuring robust security protocols across the organization.
- Detected accuracy by refining SIEM correlation rules in Splunk and IBM Q-Radar, leading to a 20% decrease in false positives and accelerating incident response times. Developed 5+ Reference Sets to bolster threat research capabilities for 10 Tier 1 SOC Analysts.
- Led comprehensive assessments of 25+ corporate systems, achieving 100% NIST compliance, mitigating 15 critical vulnerabilities, and strengthening security posture by 30% through targeted risk management.
- Developed and maintained 25+ customer-build documents, including rule logic, testing procedures, and maintenance protocols, reducing SOC team onboarding time by 40% through clear documentation and version control.
- Directed the integration of EDR and IDPS technologies within client networks, increasing detection of unauthorized access attempts by 25% and significantly improving the organization's security posture against cyber threats.

Senior Systems Engineer, Cognizant Technological Solutions

12/2020 – 12/2021 | Bengaluru, India

- Proactively monitored security events with Snort, managing over 1,000 daily IPS events and escalating 20% of high-priority incidents to senior analysts, enhancing the identification and mitigation of critical security threats.
- Developed and implemented 10+ incident response procedures within a SIEM framework, reducing false positives by 25% and enhancing alert accuracy through optimized rules and filtering.
- Conducted training modules on security operations, compliance standards, and incident response procedures, successfully aligning a team of 15 Tier 1 SOC Analysts with industry best practices, ensuring 100% SOC team compliance during annual regulatory audits.
- Engineered 100+ custom traffic pattern signatures for firewall systems, improving application-specific traffic filtering capabilities by 40% through advanced rule configuration and signature updates, increasing the system's detection accuracy.
- Monitored and analyzed security events 24/7 using Splunk, actively detecting and mitigating potential threats in real time, contributing to proactive security posturing and reducing incident response times.
- Analyzed 1,000+ security events to identify true/false positives, enhancing threat prioritization efficiency by 30% and enabling the Tier 1 SOC team to respond more swiftly to high-priority incidents.

Systems Engineer, Cognizant Technological Solutions

12/2019 – 11/2020 | Bengaluru, India

- Engineered and deployed Power Shell, and Bash scripts, automating IT processes and saving 20 hours per month.
- Employed security tools including Microsoft SCCM, SOAR, and Nessus, identifying, and mitigating over 75 vulnerabilities, resulting in a 35% improvement in system security posture.
- Monitored and managed user access rights for 500+ users, ensuring appropriate restrictions and regular reviews, resulting in a 20% decrease in unauthorized access incidents.
- Demonstrated strong Problem-Solving and Technical Skills, quickly identifying and addressing network issues, minimizing downtime, and maintaining optimal network performance.
- Improved network performance by implementing optimized routing protocols, resulting in a 20% increase in traffic efficiency and a 30% reduction in latency issues.

Security Associate Intern, Virtually Testing Foundation

Jun 2019 – Nov 2019 | Remote, India

- Led the upgrade and maintenance of an ERP platform for a medium-sized enterprise, leading to a 10% increase in operational efficiency and data accuracy.
- Created a secure web application for a local non-profit, incorporating best practice in security and cloud hosting, which increased user engagement and sensitive data protection.
- Integrated cloud hosting into a secure web application, ensuring that cloud hosting operations adhered to best security practices and compliance regulations.
- Applied compliance methodologies in upgrading and maintaining ERP platforms, ensuring that all system modifications met security and compliance regulations.

Education

Master of Science in Cyber Security, Grand Valley State University

01/2023 - 12/2024 | Grand Rapids, USA

Bachelor of Engineering in Electronics and Communication Engineering, Anna University

08/2015 - 05/2019 | Chennai, India

Certifications

- Cisco - Cyber security Essentials
- ISC2 Certified in Cyber security – ISC2 Member No. - [1886348](#)
- Microsoft Azure SC 900 - [8AAS26-C646E7](#)
- Splunk Core Certified User - [MQrhhNhm](#)
- EC-Council – Certified SOC Analyst
- EC-Council – Certified Ethical Hacker. (Equivalent to Security+) - [ECC0614392758](#)
- Qualys Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR)
- Tines Core Certification- Cert Number - [UVM2n6MAPQ](#)

Publication

Review of End-to-End Encryption in Social Networking Applications (In progress)

- Research on "End-to-End Encryption in Social Networking Applications" examines encryption protocols and impacts on user privacy across platforms.
- Security effectiveness of protocols like Signal and TLS 1.3 analyzed, contributing to digital privacy protection advancements